



Transfer Model Curriculum (TMC) Development Guidelines

This document is intended to be a comprehensive guide for Faculty Discipline Review Groups (FDRGs) as they finalize TMCs in their disciplines. The TMC development process was created and implemented during 2011. Consequently, effective practices and preferred stylistic choices have emerged. The establishment of some consistency in formatting will facilitate the understanding, review, and use of TMCs by the field, as well as simplify template development by the CCC Chancellor's Office (CCCCO) for the review and approval of TMC-aligned degrees.

Transfer Model Curriculum (TMC) Development and Review Process

A Transfer Model Curriculum (TMC) describes the major component of a CCC associate degree. Each TMC consists of a minimum of 18 semester units that is intended to describe coursework that prepares a student for transfer into a CSU major (or majors) and consists of courses that comprise the major component of a CCC degree. Below are the steps involved in the development of a TMC.

1. The development of a TMC begins with either a Faculty Discipline Review Group (FDRG) or a Discipline Input Group (DIG) meeting. Both are groups that exist within the Course Identification Numbering System (C-ID). An FDRG is a small group of discipline faculty appointed by their respective senates, typically 3 CCC and 3 CSU faculty. A DIG is a meeting where all interested faculty in the selected discipline are asked to participate in the discussion. When possible, DIGs are convened in the north and the south within a few weeks of one another. DIGs meet to review, revise, and develop C-ID descriptors. After identifying the course descriptors to be developed and, ideally, developing draft descriptors, the DIG members discuss a possible TMC. Absent a DIG meeting, the FDRG may also be charged with developing a TMC by the Intersegmental Curriculum Workgroup (ICW; see page 4 for further explanation).
2. Any TMC that was developed by an FDRG is posted for vetting. Any TMC that was developed in a DIG is reviewed by the FDRG – reconciling any differences – and then it is posted for vetting.
3. At the conclusion of the vetting period, the FDRG convenes to review comments, modify the TMC as necessary, and finalize the TMC. The final product of the FDRG will consist of the following:
 - a. TMC (the list of required courses with C-ID descriptor designations or, if a C-ID descriptor will not be developed and a course is specified, a description of the course obtained from a CCC catalog and a clarification of what articulation for that course is required).
 - b. Report of who responded to the TMC (prepared by C-ID staff).
 - c. Responses to comments, as deemed appropriate by the FDRG. The FDRG's response to the feedback received is critical and provides a mechanism for the FDRG to explain the choices made in the TMC development and, if appropriate, to offer guidance with respect to degree development.

4. When the FDRG's work on a TMC has been completed, a subcommittee of the ICW is convened to review the work of the FDRG and to determine whether or not all processes have been followed. The subcommittee consists of 3 faculty from the CCC and 3 faculty from the CSU that are members of the ICW. Typically, the FDRG lead will attend the meeting to address questions about the finalized TMC. If it is determined that all processes were followed and all TMC criteria are met, the finalized TMC is formally accepted and the TMC development process is deemed completed.
5. Once a TMC is finalized, it is sent to the CCCCCO for the development of a template to be used by colleges submitting TMC-aligned degrees. In addition, the CSU Chancellor's Office forwards the finalized TMC to CSU campuses for determination and coding of "similar" majors.

TMC Standards and Acceptance Criteria

The development of TMCs is an effort to provide a statewide response to the implementation of Senate Bill 1440 (Padilla, 2010) that has been codified in law as California Education Code §66745 – 66749.

TMC-aligned degrees will consist of courses that are appropriate for an AA or AS in a major and would be sufficient preparation for transfer into a given major or group of majors at the CSU. There has long been an interest in simplifying transfer such that a student could prepare for a major – without having already selected a transfer destination. It is with this goal in mind that these degrees are to be developed – what does an 18 unit major look like that is both appropriate for an AA in a given discipline **and** that adequately prepares a student for transfer in that discipline?

Faculty convened for the purpose of developing TMCs are expected to:

1. Identify, ideally, a minimum of 6 units of "core" courses for the TMC. The "core" of the TMC must be consistent across all colleges that develop degrees aligned with the TMC.
2. Specify the additional components of the TMC (a minimum of 18 semester units, total, in the major are required).
3. Be sensitive to local limitations and provide options for colleges that allow for flexibility, where possible.
4. Make efforts to minimize student unit accumulation by providing an opportunity to "double-count" courses for the major and other requirements (i.e., general education and, where appropriate, CSU graduation requirements such as American history and institutions). Where such possibilities exist, double counting should be noted (please see the sample at the end of this document).
5. Include titles and C-ID designations to identify courses in the TMC. In those instances where no C-ID descriptor will be developed, sample course descriptions must be submitted when the FDRG chooses to identify specific courses. When specific courses are identified the general education or major preparation articulation that will be required must be explicitly indicated. Actual course descriptions of articulated courses from community college catalogs should be used. *Note: C-ID descriptors will be developed for all the required courses in a TMC. Colleges seeking approval of TMC-aligned degrees are now required to submit their courses to C-ID.*

TMC Structural Notes

As noted, the TMC begins with a “core”. After the determination of what courses should comprise the core, additional courses options are indicated to specify a degree of at least 18 semester units. Typically, this involves indicating that courses are to be selected from one or more lists. It is expected that these lists be of decreasing specificity. For example, the core might consist of three 3-unit courses. List A might be a list of three to five 3-unit courses with an indication that the degree would consist of one course from List A. List B might be a longer list of 3-unit courses that includes List A and also “any course articulated at a CSU as major preparation in the discipline” with an indication that the degree would consist of one course from List B. The final List C might again be a “select one” list and consist of courses from List A, List B, and any CSU-transferable course in the discipline. Such a structure is intended to ensure that each CCC can develop a degree that will serve their local CSU well and introduces flexibility within the TMC that will facilitate degree portability, as is encouraged by the legislation. As noted earlier, a review of existing TMCs is encouraged to see examples of what has been described.

TMC Minimum Specifications

1. The TMC must describe a major that is a minimum of 18 semester units. The TMC may consist of more than 18 units, but must be designed to be a minimum of 18.
2. A TMC must be designed such that a TMC-aligned degree can be completed within 60 units. Without double-counting, a student would typically accumulate at least 57 units when working towards a degree with a major of 18 units (39 units for CSU GE breadth + 18 units in the major). If there are opportunities for double-counting, the units in the TMC may exceed 21.
3. There is a specified “core” of at least 6 semester units consisting of required courses or selection from a list of courses with restricted options.
4. The 120 CSU unit limit must be considered. California Education Code (CEC) §66748 states that “The California State University may require a student transferring pursuant to this article to take additional courses at the California State University so long as the student is not required to take any more than 60 additional semester units or 90 quarter units at the California State University for majors requiring 120 semester units or 180 quarter units.” Faculty developing a TMC, and responding to the TMC during the vetting process, should consider whether or not TMC-aligned degrees will prepare students sufficiently for the completion of the major at the CSU within an additional 60 semester units.
5. All courses in a TMC must be CSU transferable. (CEC § 66746)
6. Only one course (3-4 units) may be permitted in either of the categories below:
 - a. Unarticulated OR
 - b. Left unspecified as a general list that does not specify articulation as preparation for the major, such as “any course in the discipline” or “any CSU GE area D course”
7. Double-counting opportunities should be considered and indicated.

The above information pertains to the development of a TMC. Following the development of a draft TMC by a DIG, the FDRG is convened to reconcile any

differences before the TMC is posted at www.c-id.net for statewide vetting. Vetting is typically conducted for a period of at least one month and during periods when faculty are available (September – May). FDRGs are responsible for preparing the TMC for vetting, reviewing and responding to the feedback obtained during the vetting process, and preparing the final TMC recommendation for review by a faculty subcommittee of the SB 1440 Intersegmental Curriculum Workgroup (ICW). The ICW is charged with making curricular determinations with respect to the implementation of SB 1440. A faculty sub-group of the ICW will make the final determination as to the status of the TMC based on the criteria specified in this document. This subgroup is comprised of six faculty, three appointed by the CSU academic senate and three appointed by the CCC academic senate.

In preparing a TMC for review by the ICW, the FDRG will review and respond to the “TMC Criteria Checklist” (see page 12) and provide the following with the recommendation for acceptance:

1. The TMC with **C-ID designations or sample catalog descriptions** of all specified courses.
2. A list of the proposed **CSU major or majors** for which the TMC is designed as preparation for.
3. An overview of the **vetting process**. Every effort should be made to reach discipline faculty in the CCC and CSU. The FDRG lead will write a narrative explaining the efforts made. The ASCCC office will prepare a summary of the responses.
4. A **narrative responding to concerns** raised in the vetting process. It should be evident that identified issues were considered and handled in a manner deemed appropriate by the FDRG.
5. **If the recommended TMC is a significant departure from the TMC as vetted**, an explanation as to the efforts made to vet the revised version should be provided.
6. **The FDRG should identify whether the degree will be an AA-T or an AS-T.** An AS-T designation should be selected for majors in the sciences, mathematics and CTE fields. An AA-T designation is for all other majors.



Transfer Model Curriculum Worksheet

Approval Dates: Month 20XX; Month X, 20XX (Cal-GETC Compliance)

CCC Associate Degree for Transfer Major or Area of Emphasis: _____

CSU Majors deemed similar: _____

Degree Type: _____

Total Minimum Semester Units for Major or Area of Emphasis: _____

COURSES

Required Core – (X units)

Title	C-ID Designation or other Justification	C-ID Units (or sample units)	Proposed Cal-GETC Area (for double counting)

List A – Select X courses, X units, from the following:

Title	C-ID Designation or other Justification	C-ID Units (or sample units)	Proposed Cal-GETC Area (for double counting)

List B – Select X courses, X units, from the following:

Title	C-ID Designation or other Justification	C-ID Units (or sample units)	Proposed Cal-GETC Area (for double counting)

List C – Select X courses, X units, from the following:

Title	C-ID Designation or other Justification	C-ID Units (or sample units)	Proposed Cal-GETC Area (for double counting)

TOTAL MAJOR UNITS	XX
Cal-GETC Requirements	34
Double Counting GE	-
Elective	-
Total Units	60

** All units are based on the semester and indicated minimum units. The major must be a minimum of 18 semester units.*

TMC Narrative and Stylistic Guidelines

Before beginning TMC development or editing a vetted TMC, a review of already finalized and approved TMCs is encouraged. There may be an existing TMC that provides a model for a challenge that your discipline may be facing. Finalized TMCs can be viewed at www.c-id.net.

One of the most challenging aspects of TMC development, for some disciplines, is the unit cap. A TMC must be designed such that a TMC-aligned associate degree can be completed in no more than 60 units. A transferable GE pattern + a TMC may be less than 60 units – which would be ideal to permit students some true elective choices. A given student may opt to exceed 60 units. This unit cap may result in difficult choices for some disciplines. Where a discipline must exclude courses that a student would greatly benefit from taking prior to transfer, the FDRG may include suggestions in its narrative for colleges to consider including in their catalogs. For example, the Chemistry FDRG included the following recommendation:

Recommended Preparation: Students are strongly recommended to take Calculus-based Physics I & II (C-ID PHYS 205 & 210) before transfer. Contact your local transfer institution(s) for specific requirements.

While degrees must be completed within 60 units, additional units can still be transferred, up to the limit allowable by CSU. In many of the highly-sequenced disciplines, hard choices may have to be made to “fit” in the SB 1440 framework. While SB 1440 allows for exceptions for “high unit” majors, these are exceptions that would be reflected in the unit cap at the CSU. “High unit” has been defined as bachelor's degrees that require more than 120 semester units.

Another issue that frequently emerges is the question of including prerequisites. When does a prerequisite have to be included in a TMC? The community colleges have been instructed to include prerequisites in the degree requirements when ALL students are required to take them. If some students can place into the required course, then it's acceptable to note that there *may* be prerequisites, but it's not required to include them in the unit count for the major or in the degree. This rule applies to TMC development; local practices may vary. While a TMC may not factor in a potential prerequisite course due to the “placing out” option (i.e., placing into the required course), if a given community college requires a prerequisite that is CSU transferable and there is no “placing out” option, those units must be counted in the units that must be completed to earn the degree. For example, if calculus were a required course for the major and the college had a pre-calculus course that was CSU transferable and placing out of that course is not an option, then the pre-calculus class and its units would need to be included in the degree.

While all required courses will be identified by C-ID descriptors, the FDRG may opt to specify courses for which no C-ID descriptor will be developed. When identifying a particular course in a TMC, a descriptor reference or a catalog description must be provided. In many instances disciplines have opted to allow courses to be used that meet specified articulation requirements. Some examples include the following:

Any CSU transferable Administration of Justice lower division course or courses outside the Administration of Justice discipline that are articulated as lower division major preparation for the Criminal Justice or Criminology Major at any CSU.

Any studio arts course that transfers as CSU GE or as major preparation for the studio arts major or similar major at the CSU.

Any course articulated as CSU GE Area C2 in: A Language other than English (except ASL); Art, History, Humanities; Philosophy; Religion/Religious Studies

It is important that the intent of the FDRG be clear when a TMC is reviewed. A narrative that explains the decision-making process can help inform the field as to how and why decisions were made. Units or courses may be indicated from the options provided in a TMC. The indicated units must show the minimum semester units; a range may also be indicated, if warranted. The final unit count for a TMC should reflect what is common at most community colleges.

As demonstrated in the Transfer Model Curriculum Worksheet (see page 5) and the existing TMCs, each TMC begins with some sort of “required core.” Ideally, this consists of at least 2 courses. After that, the specificity of the TMC may diminish. Again, existing TMCs are the best guide.

The “required core” should be designated as such. Any courses that are required should be included in this core. After that, colleges should be asked to select courses and/or units from designated list labeled “List A”, “List B”, etc. Where courses are not specified by a C-ID descriptor, the necessary articulation must be specified.

It is also useful to provide a rationale for each course and note possible GE applicability. This facilitates determining the actual unit count, degree development, and template creation by the CCCCCO.

C-ID, SB 1440, and TMCs – Frequently Asked Questions

Revised March 5, 2013

The TMC is an effort to respond to the creation of community college “associate degree for transfer” in a coordinated statewide manner. Once finalized, each TMC will delineate a curriculum that, if adopted, provides a community college with a fast-tracked approval process (community college degrees must be approved locally and by the Chancellor’s Office) – and also provides a structure to the degree that has been developed and vetted by intersegmental discipline faculty. SB 1440 effectively makes a community college AA-T/AS-T degree one mechanism for transferring to the CSU and an option that provides guarantees to the student. This legislation establishes a community college degree as the major preparation for transfer and prohibits the CSU from requiring students to repeat “similar” courses – and caps the units required by the CSU at 60 semester units (all references to units are semester units, for simplicity and consistency). The community colleges provide 60 units of the baccalaureate degree; the CSU provides the “finishing” 60. Note that there is a stated exception for “high unit” majors – but the details of this have not been worked out yet. What has been clarified, at this time, is that “high unit” will be determined by the total units required at the CSU – the CCC degrees cannot exceed 60. While CCC degrees must be designed to consist of no more than 60 units, the CSU will continue to use and apply units over the required 60, as appropriate.

The ASCCC will add to this list and provide additional information as it becomes available. Please see the website at www.asccc.org for updates and new FAQs.

1. In order for a community college to adopt the TMC, must their courses align with the C-ID descriptors?

Yes, when a C-ID descriptor exists. While community colleges were initially allowed to “self-certify” that their course matched a C-ID descriptor or to demonstrate articulation to bypass the need to “self-certify”, effective January 1, 2013, all AA-T and AS-T proposals submitted to the Chancellor’s Office for review and approval must demonstrate that courses included in the degree have been submitted for C-ID numbers, where descriptors exist. By June 1, 2013, for any existing AA-T and AS-T degrees that included a self-certification that a course or courses matched a C-ID descriptor, colleges are required to submit those courses for C-ID approval where descriptors exist.

2. In order for a community college to create a TMC-aligned degree, must their courses be submitted to C-ID?

Yes. Effective January 1, 2013, all AA-T and AS-T proposals submitted to the Chancellor’s Office for review and approval must demonstrate that courses included in the degree have been submitted for C-ID numbers, where descriptors exist.

3. Why are there upper division courses listed in some of the TMC?

All TMCs should reflect the courses required for major preparation at a CSU. If a course has been included in an approved TMC, then it is lower division and, where a course exists at the upper and lower division level, the C-ID descriptor describes the lower division version of the course.

4. If a community college cannot offer all of the required courses in a given TMC, does this mean an SB 1440 degree can’t be offered by that college?

No. A college in such a circumstance could choose to develop the necessary course and delay the development of that degree until such time as the course is available. Sensitivity to local limitations has been encouraged in the development of all TMC, but there will be instances where a community college simply cannot support one or more required courses for the TMC.

5. Most community colleges offer broad “areas of emphasis” that allow a student to take what they need for a variety of majors. If these degrees conformed to the other elements of SB 1440, couldn’t they fill the need for an “associate degree for transfer”?

It would depend. If an area of emphasis were defined enough so as to ensure student preparation for one or more specific majors, maybe. But an area of emphasis that is so unstructured that it effectively is a unique degree for every student would not prepare a student for any given major at the CSU. SB 1440 grants a student access to a major based on the degree completed at the community college – not the behavior of an individual student. This is a departure from how the system has always operated.

6. Does a CSU have to count all of the courses in an associate degree for transfer towards the CSU degree? In other words, does a CSU have to make all the courses in the TMC for a given major “work” in their major?

No. Units in the TMC that are not counted towards the CSU major would be lower division elective units.

7. Given that units vary for some courses across our colleges, a 60 unit major at one community college might be a 62 unit major at another. Given these variations, may an “SB 1440 degree” exceed 60 units?

No. The language in the legislation is very clear. Degrees that are developed in response to SB 1440 must not exceed 60 units. Students may, of course, take additional units beyond the required 60 – and, if those units are applicable to their course of study at the CSU, they will be used. While it is certainly preferable for students in “highly sequenced” majors (physics and chemistry, for example) to take more units at the community college, SB 1440 degrees cannot exceed 60 units.

8. The units required for major preparation at the CSU vary considerably – from zero to well over forty. How can requiring students to take a minimum of 18 units in a community college major be justified, given this variation?

No student is obligated to complete any degree – the introduction of these degrees does not prevent students from pursuing traditional transfer pathways. CCC degrees have always had a minimum unit requirement for the major component of the degree. SB 1440 reinforces the 18 unit requirement. Students who complete these degrees will be given highest priority for admission purposes and will enter the CSU with no more than 60 units to complete to earn a Bachelor’s Degree. These are students who will have priority over other students who might have a higher GPA – the completion of these degrees should have a minimum level of rigor to justify the benefits they confer.

9. SB 1440 degrees “cap” the units that can be required at the CCC at 60 units. If such degrees are created for majors where students historically have done more lower division units before transfer, such as highly sequence majors in the sciences, won’t these students be ill-prepared for transfer?

The Education Code sections that serve to implement SB 1440 dictate that CCC degrees created in response to SB 1440 must be of no more than 60 units. This will necessarily result in challenges for some disciplines - but this is what the law calls for. It is likely that students will pursue a degree of 60 units, as required, but then be encouraged to complete more units at the CCC. True "high unit" majors are being identified by the CSU and would not have the 60-unit CSU limit imposed. The ultimate consequence may be that more lower division units in some areas being completed at the CSU.

10. How will "similar" courses be defined?

This has yet to be formally determined, but C-ID descriptors do serve as a means of defining the lower division version of a given course.

TMC Criteria Checklist

Discipline

TMC Vetting

Questions	Response
1. Was the TMC vetted appropriately? a. CSU and CCC involvement b. Number of respondents c. Discipline d. Time	
2. Were identified issues dealt with appropriately?	
3. If the recommended TMC is a departure from the TMC as vetted, have the changes been adequately vetted?	

TMC minimum Requirements

Questions	Response
1. Is the major a minimum of 18 units?	
2. Can a TMC-aligned degree be completed within 60 units?	
3. Is there a specified "core" of at least 6 semester units consisting of required courses or selection from a list of courses with restricted options?	
4. Did the group consider the 120 CSU limit?	
5. Are all courses CSU transferable?	
6. Is no more than one course (3 – 4 units) permitted in either of these categories below? a. Unarticulated b. Left unspecified as a general list that does not specify articulation as preparation for the major, such as "any course in the discipline" or "any CSU GE area D course" <i>Note: TMC-aligned degrees must list specific courses.</i>	
7. Were double-counting opportunities considered?	
8. If a CCC opts to provide only one option in any category that course must be articulated as general education or major preparation at the CSU. Is the TMC consistent with this restriction?	
9. Was there input from transfer specialists in the development of the TMC?	

Approval- Approved by ICW the faculty subgroup:

CSU: _____ Date _____

CCC: _____ Date _____

Comments/Concerns

Academic Senate Office

Recorded by:

Appendix: Transfer Model Curriculum (TMC) Development

